

graduated in 1903, Bartók was already in great demand as a pianist (his early recordings display his distinctively clear and beautiful tone) and in 1907, he was appointed to a piano professorship at the Academy, a post that he held until 1934.



EDISON PHONOGRAPH, c.1900

Bartók and Kodály's research into folk song was made possible by the invention of sound-recording equipment, such as Edison's phonograph. From 1934 to 1940, Bartók compiled an edition of 13,000 Hungarian folk songs that he had collected, for the Hungarian Academy of Sciences.

Field studies

With the Hapsburg Empire in crisis after the suicide of Crown Prince Rudolf in 1889 destabilized the monarchy, Hungarian